

Word Ladders

Change ONE letter each step — grades 2-3

Name _____

Date _____

Start at the top word. Change **one letter** on each step to make a new real word, until you reach the bottom word.

Ladder 1

C	O	S	T
L	I	N	E

Ladder 2

R	E	A	L
S	O	L	D

Ladder 3

C	O	D	E
H	A	R	D

Ladder 4

F	A	C	T
M	A	R	K

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Answer Key

Sample answers. Any ladder is correct if every step changes just one letter and makes a real word.

Ladder 1

C	O	S	T
M	O	S	T
M	I	S	T
M	I	N	T
M	I	N	E
L	I	N	E

Ladder 2

R	E	A	L
R	E	A	D
R	O	A	D
T	O	A	D
T	O	L	D
S	O	L	D

Ladder 3

C	O	D	E
C	O	M	E
C	A	M	E
C	A	R	E
C	A	R	D
H	A	R	D

Ladder 4

F	A	C	T
F	A	S	T
P	A	S	T
P	A	R	T
P	A	R	K
M	A	R	K